

# Insurance English Jargon Quick Reference

Field-specific terms, contrast pairs, and high-pressure sentence frames

**Audience: underwriters, claims adjusters, brokers, risk managers, actuarial analysts, policy-service teams, compliance staff, and insurance operations leaders**

Focus: An insurance English curriculum for underwriting, claims, policy language, coverage disputes, actuarial assumptions, broker communication, fraud concerns, compliance, and customer escalation.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

## Nomenclature and Jargon

These are classroom working definitions. Learners should adapt wording to their organization's policies, systems, and local regulatory environment.

### Underwriting and Risk Selection

| Term          | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| underwriting  | Working insurance term used in underwriting and risk selection; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| risk appetite | Working insurance term used in underwriting and risk selection; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| exposure      | Working insurance term used in underwriting and risk selection; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| loss history  | Working insurance term used in underwriting and risk selection; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |

### Policy Language and Coverage Interpretation

| Term        | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| policy      | Formal rule or standard that guides decisions and behavior.                                                                                                                                |
| endorsement | Working insurance term used in policy language and coverage interpretation; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| exclusion   | Working insurance term used in policy language and coverage interpretation; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| coverage    | Working insurance term used in policy language and coverage interpretation; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |

### Claims Intake and Reserving

| Term          | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                            |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| claim         | A statement that may need evidence, approval, qualification, or disclosure before it is used externally.                                                                   |
| reserve       | Working insurance term used in claims intake and reserving; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| proof of loss | Working insurance term used in claims intake and reserving; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| adjuster      | Working insurance term used in claims intake and reserving; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |

### Coverage Disputes and Denials

| Term                  | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| denial                | Working insurance term used in coverage disputes and denials; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| reservation of rights | Working insurance term used in coverage disputes and denials; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| appeal                | Working insurance term used in coverage disputes and denials; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |

| Term              | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                              |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| coverage position | Working insurance term used in coverage disputes and denials; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |

## Broker and Client Renewal Meetings

| Term        | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| renewal     | Working insurance term used in broker and client renewal meetings; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| premium     | Working insurance term used in broker and client renewal meetings; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| deductible  | Working insurance term used in broker and client renewal meetings; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| reinsurance | Working insurance term used in broker and client renewal meetings; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |

## Fraud Indicators and SIU Referral

| Term                       | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                  |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| fraud indicator            | Working insurance term used in fraud indicators and siu referral; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| SIU                        | Working insurance term used in fraud indicators and siu referral; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| material misrepresentation | Working insurance term used in fraud indicators and siu referral; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| investigation              | Working insurance term used in fraud indicators and siu referral; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |

## Actuarial Assumptions and Pricing

| Term             | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| loss development | Working insurance term used in actuarial assumptions and pricing; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| frequency        | Working insurance term used in actuarial assumptions and pricing; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| severity         | Working insurance term used in actuarial assumptions and pricing; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| reserve adequacy | Working insurance term used in actuarial assumptions and pricing; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |

## Compliance, Market Conduct, and Complaints

| Term           | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                           |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| market conduct | Working insurance term used in compliance, market conduct, and complaints; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| complaint      | Working insurance term used in compliance, market conduct, and complaints; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |

| Term                 | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                           |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| timely communication | Working insurance term used in compliance, market conduct, and complaints; define the owner, evidence source, governing document, risk, and decision impact before using it in a meeting. |
| corrective action    | Action taken to fix a current problem and prevent recurrence.                                                                                                                             |

## Industry-Specific Meeting Moves

| Situation                                   | Useful language                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Underwriting and Risk Selection             | Before we commit, I want to confirm underwriting, risk appetite, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If exposure, loss history, controls, appetite, and pricing adequacy need explanation., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.          |
| Policy Language and Coverage Interpretation | Before we commit, I want to confirm policy, endorsement, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If policy terms, exclusions, endorsements, facts, and claims review may control., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.                       |
| Claims Intake and Reserving                 | Before we commit, I want to confirm claim, reserve, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If coverage, documentation, liability, damages, and reserve review are needed., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.                              |
| Coverage Disputes and Denials               | Before we commit, I want to confirm denial, reservation of rights, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If facts, policy language, legal review, appeal rights, and tone matter., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.                     |
| Broker and Client Renewal Meetings          | Before we commit, I want to confirm renewal, premium, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If loss trends, exposure growth, reinsurance, capacity, and terms need explanation., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.                       |
| Fraud Indicators and SIU Referral           | Before we commit, I want to confirm fraud indicator, SIU, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If evidence, investigation process, documentation, and legal boundaries matter., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.                       |
| Actuarial Assumptions and Pricing           | Before we commit, I want to confirm loss development, frequency, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If loss development, frequency, severity, assumptions, and confidence ranges need translation., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step. |
| Compliance, Market Conduct, and Complaints  | Before we commit, I want to confirm market conduct, complaint, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If market-conduct rules, timelines, evidence, corrective action, and monitoring are needed., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.      |

## High-pressure pushback frames

- I understand the urgency. The risk is that we move faster than the evidence or process supports.
- I am not blocking the goal. I am naming the condition we need before the decision is safe and credible.
- If we accept this risk, we should name the owner, document the assumption, and define the trigger for escalation.
- That may be possible, but not under the current scope, timeline, or approval path.
- Let's separate what we know, what we assume, and what still needs confirmation.

## Contrast Pairs

| Do not confuse               | Useful distinction                                                                                                                                                             |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| underwriting vs loss history | In underwriting and risk selection, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision. |

| Do not confuse                       | Useful distinction                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| policy vs coverage                   | In policy language and coverage interpretation, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision. |
| claim vs adjuster                    | In claims intake and reserving, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.                 |
| denial vs coverage position          | In coverage disputes and denials, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.               |
| renewal vs reinsurance               | In broker and client renewal meetings, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.          |
| fraud indicator vs investigation     | In fraud indicators and siu referral, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.           |
| loss development vs reserve adequacy | In actuarial assumptions and pricing, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.           |
| market conduct vs corrective action  | In compliance, market conduct, and complaints, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.  |